BRIEF ON WAITHAKA FOUNDATION FOR THE ELDERLY



7TH NOVEMBER, 2026

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1.0 ESTABLISHMENT OF THE FOUNDATION

The Waithaka Foundation is a non-profit Community Based Organization (CBO) dedicated to promoting the health, dignity and well-being of senior citizens (over 80 years of age). The foundation was started in 2022 as a response to the growing challenges faced by senior citizens in Kabuku, Limuru areas of Kiambu County. The challenges included isolation, poor health, poverty and limited access to healthcare and social support. The organization started as Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) by the late Waithaka's family as a way of giving back to the society. The foundation is based in Limuru Sub-County where it is serving a hundred registered members.

1.1 MISSION

The elderly are important repositories of our heritage and pillars of our community. Yet, the twilight years for many of our senior citizens are marked by profound neglect, isolation and acute healthcare challenges.
The foundation exists to honor, protect, restore hope, comfort and dignity to senior citizens by providing compassionate care, community-based support and spiritual nourishment. In providing this support the foundation, collaborate with families of the members, volunteers and local leaders.

1.2 CORE VALUES

The elderly persons deserve safety, comfort, love and peace in their sunset years. The foundation is therefore guided by the following core values in all its operations:

- **Compassion** - Serving with empathy.
- **Respect** - Honoring the life of every senior citizen.
- **Integrity** - Operating with transparency and honesty.
- **Inclusivity** - Welcoming all elderly individuals in need.
- **Service** - Dedicating efforts to uplifting the vulnerable groups.

1.3 OBJECTIVES

i. Improve the quality of life of the senior citizens through spiritual nourishment and; compassionate and reliable care services.
ii. Minimize loneliness and social isolation among senior citizens through companionship and community engagement programming.
iii. Promote physical, emotional and mental well-being of elderly persons.
iv. Support vulnerable and disadvantaged elderly individuals especially those living alone and in poverty.
v. Advocate for the rights, dignity and inclusion of elderly persons within the community.
vi. Strengthen family and community involvement in care and support of the elderly.

2.0 PROGRAMMES AND IMPLEMENTATION MODALITIES

2.1 PROGRAMMES

In its present form the organization implements the following programs:

i. **Companionship and Emotional Support**

Holds monthly meetings for fellowship conversations, listening and emotional support. Such forums are held with the aim of reducing loneliness, depression and social isolation. These events are held in rented premises like halls and open grounds.

ii. **Food and other essential supplies**

The foundation distributes food stuff and other essential home supplies during the monthly events.

iii. **Health and Wellness Support**

The foundation organizes health checkups and referrals to health facilities for the senior citizens. The organization also arranges follow up support for members with chronic illnesses.

2.2 IMPLEMENTATION MODALITIES

In carrying out the monthly events the foundation engages in the following activities:

a) Rent of premises & facilities
b) Supply of food stuff and others
c) Hire of Facilitators
d) Medical supplies
e) Transport of the elderly

The events are supported by well-wishers, donors and the Waithaka family.

3.0 GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE AND STAFFING

3.1 BOARD

The foundation is managed by a Board of Directors and a Board Secretary (Executive Officer). It is expected that in its operations the Board will be supported by a secretariat headed by the Executive officer. Within the Board there will be three key Committees i.e. the Audit Committee, the Human Resource Committee and the Governance Committee.

3.2 STAFFING

The Board will require ten (10) people to manage the affairs of the foundation. This will act like the Board's secretariat.

4.0 CONCLUSION

Waithaka foundation operates from hired facilities like halls and open fields whenever an event is planned. This makes it difficult and complicated to support a sizeable number of senior citizens. Many would like to participate in the activities, but cannot make it due to transport challenges. In order to reach more senior citizens, the foundation intends to build a Waithaka foundation complex. The foundation has therefore organized the fundraising to assist in purchasing a piece of land for this purpose.